

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

-----X	:	
Louchie Brown,	:	
	:	Index Number:
	:	Date Purchased:
	:	Date Filed:
Plaintiff,	:	SUMMONS
-against-	:	
City of New York, New York City Police Department,	:	
Police Officer George Hines, Shield 5160 of the 48	:	
Precinct, Sergeant Franklin Bonilla, Tax Reg #943010 of	:	
the 48 Precinct and New York City Police Officers John	:	
Doe,	:	
	:	Plaintiff's residence is:
	:	1160 Bryant Avenue
	:	Bronx, NY 10459
Defendants,	:	
-----X	:	

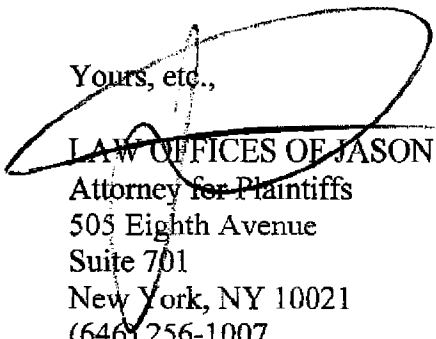
TO THE ABOVE NAMED DEFENDANTS:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to Answer the Verified Complaint in this action and serve a copy of your answer, or if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons to serve a notice of Appearance on the Plaintiffs attorney within twenty (20) days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within thirty (30) days after the service is complete if this Summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York) and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the Verified Complaint.

The basis of venue designated is that the cause of action arose in Bronx County.

Dated: March 13, 2020
New York, NY

Yours, etc.,



LAW OFFICES OF JASON A. STEINBERGER, LLC
Attorney for Plaintiffs
505 Eighth Avenue
Suite 701
New York, NY 10021
(646) 256-1007

To: City of New York

New York City Police Department

Police Officer George Hines, Shield 5160 of the 48 Precinct

Sergeant Franklin Bonilla, Tax Reg #943010 of the 48 Precinct

New York City Police Officers John Doe

Loucchie Brown.

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

-against-

City of New York, New York City Police Department, :
Police Officer George Hines, Shield 5160 of the 48 :
Precinct, Sergeant Franklin Bonilla, Tax Reg #943010 of :
the 48 Precinct and New York City Police Officers John :
Doe. :

Defendants

STATEMENT OF FACTS

- 3 of 12

4. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, the New York City Police Officers John Doe (hereinafter referred to as "DOES") were employed by the New York City Police Department.

5. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Defendant City of New York, is a municipal corporation organized and existing under the laws of the State of New York, with a principal place of business located at 1 Centre Street, County of New York State of New York.

6. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Defendant New York City Police Department, is an agency created and maintained by the above municipal government.

7. On or about May 16, 2019 notice required by Municipal Law 50-E was given to City of New York, by personal service. Said notice set forth the facts underlying Plaintiffs' claim against the City of New York, and its agents and employees. To date, no answer has been received by Plaintiff and no compensation has been offered by the City of New York.

8. That on or about August 29, 2019, a hearing required by Municipal Law 50-H was conducted. At said hearing, Plaintiff testified and set forth the facts underlying Plaintiffs' claim against the City of New York and its agents and employees. To date, no answer has been received by Plaintiff and no compensation has been offered by the City of New York in response to this claim, and more than thirty (30) days have elapsed.

9. That on or about May 11, 2017 at approximately 12:00 PM in the vicinity of East 179 and Bronx Park Avenue, Bronx, New York, Plaintiff observed HINES, BONILLA and DOES stop and search three of Plaintiff's friends.

10. That Plaintiff, by way of his cellular phone, took video of the interaction.

11. That HINES, BONILLA and DOES instructed Plaintiff to back away.

12. That at all times, Plaintiff complied with each and every direction given by HINES, BONILLA and DOES.

13. That Plaintiff then walked away from HINES, BONILLA and DOES and that HINES, BONILLA and DOES followed Plaintiff.
14. That HINES, BONILLA and DOES stopped, handcuffed and arrested Plaintiff.
15. That at no time did Plaintiff possess marijuana.
16. That at no time did Plaintiff engage in any unlawful or illegal behavior.
17. That after Plaintiff was arrested, he was transported to the 48 precinct.
18. That while Plaintiff was held in the 48 precinct he was confined to a cell with numerous other male prisoners.
19. That while Plaintiff was held in the 48 precinct he was strip searched and that nothing illegal was found.
20. That after being held in the 48 precinct for several hours, he was transported to Bronx County Central Booking, located at 265 East 161 Street, Bronx, NY.
21. That while Plaintiff was held in Bronx County Central Booking, he was confined to a cell with numerous other male prisoners.
22. That on or about May 12, 2017 Plaintiff was arraigned on docket 2017BX027025 wherein he was charged with Criminal Possession of Marijuana and Unlawful Possession of Marijuana.
23. That at the arraignment, Plaintiff was released and ordered to return to court.
24. That on and between May 12, 2017 and April 25, 2019 Plaintiff made numerous court appearances until the case against Plaintiff was dismissed upon application of the Office of the Bronx County District Attorney.

AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST DEFENDANTS

25. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 24, as if more fully stated herein at length.

26. That Defendants acted with actual malice toward Plaintiff and with willful and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for the statutory and constitutional rights of the Plaintiff.

27. That the actions of the Defendants constituted unreasonable deprivation of liberty without due process of law.

28. That as a result of the actions by Defendants, Plaintiff was traumatized and fears his physical safety when he sees and encounters members of the New York City Police Department from that day and onward.

29. That as a result of the Defendants' actions, Plaintiff has been unable to sleep.

30. That as a result of the Defendants' actions Plaintiff sustained damage to his person in the sum within the jurisdiction of the Supreme Court and in excess of all inferior courts.

AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST DEFENDANTS

31. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 30, as if more fully stated herein at length.

32. The intentional verbal abuse, false arrest, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution by Defendants violated the rights of the Plaintiff as guaranteed by the Fourth, Fifth and Eighth Amendments to the United States Constitution, as well as the corresponding sections of the New York State Constitution, for which Defendants are individually liable.

33. Defendants having no lawful authority to arrest Plaintiff, did, nevertheless, unlawfully arrest Plaintiff with actual malice toward him and with willful and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for his constitutional rights. Thus Plaintiff is entitled to both compensatory and exemplary damages.

AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST DEFENDANTS

34. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 33, as if more fully stated herein at length.

35. Defendants conspired to violate Plaintiff's statutory civil rights in violation of 42 U.S.C. sec.1983, et al as well as the corresponding sections of the New York State Constitution, for which Defendants are individually liable. Thus Plaintiff is entitled to both compensatory and exemplary damages, as well as attorney's fees.

AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST DEFENDANTS

36. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 35, as if more fully stated herein at length.

37. Plaintiff was verbally abused, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned and maliciously prosecuted by Defendants in a manner that was extreme, outrageous and unjustified and caused Plaintiff to suffer physical and severe emotional distress for which the Defendants are individually liable. The verbal abuse, false arrest, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution on and of Plaintiff by Defendants were unjustified and done with actual malice and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for human life and the rights of Plaintiff. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

38. That during the pendency of the case, Defendants maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff by continuing to cooperate in a prosecution when Plaintiff should never have been arrested.

Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

39. That prior to the time of arrest, after the arrest and during the pendency of the criminal case against Plaintiff, HINES, BONILLA and DOES persisted in their false claim that Plaintiff possessed marijuana despite their being video footage to the contrary.

**AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST CITY OF NEW YORK AND
NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**

40. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 39, as if more fully stated herein at length.

41. At all times pertinent hereto, HINES, HUBBARD and DOES were acting within the scope of her employment as officers of the New York City Police Department and City of New York.

42. The City of New York and New York City Police Department are each liable for compensatory damages under the doctrine of respondeat superior for the intentional torts that HINES, HUBBARD and DOES committed within the scope of her employment.

**AS AND FOR A SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST CITY OF NEW YORK AND
NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**

43. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 42, as if more fully stated herein at length.

44. The City of New York and New York City Police Department's failure to provide adequate training and supervision to HINES, HUBBARD and DOES constitutes a willful and

wanton indifference and deliberate disregard for human life and the rights of private citizens, including Plaintiff. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory exemplary damages.

**AS AND FOR A SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST CITY OF NEW YORK
AND NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**

45. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 44 as if more fully stated herein at length.

46. Upon information and belief, the City of New York and New York City Police Department maintained a system of review of police conduct which was so untimely and cursory that it was ineffective and permitted and tolerated the unreasonable detention of Plaintiff.

47. Upon information and belief, the City of New York and New York City Police Department maintained a system of review of police conduct which was so untimely and cursory that it was ineffective and permitted the wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for the statutory and constitutional rights of Plaintiff.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiffs each demand judgment against the Defendants as follows:

On the first cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts;

On the second cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts, together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the willful and wanton nature of Defendants actions.

On the third cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of

this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the willful and wanton nature of Defendants actions.

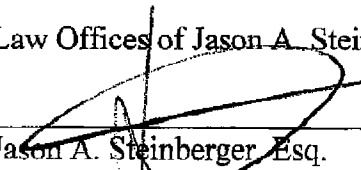
On the fourth cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the wanton and willful nature of the Defendants actions;

On the fifth cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts

On the sixth cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts.

On the seventh cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts.

Law Offices of Jason A. Steinberger, LLC

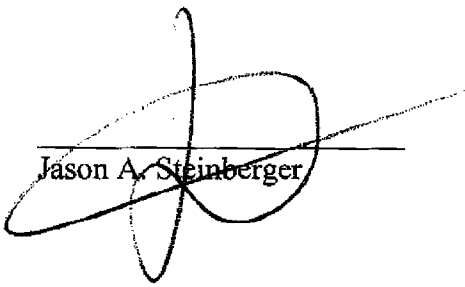


Jason A. Steinberger Esq.
Attorney for Plaintiffs
505 Eighth Avenue
Suite 701
New York, NY 10021
(646) 256-1007

STATE OF NEW YORK: COUNTY OF NEW YORK

The undersigned, an attorney admitted to practice in the State of New York, under penalties of perjury, affirms the following to be true: Affirmant has read the foregoing Complaint and the contents thereof ; the same is true to affirmant's own knowledge, except as to matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief and as to those matters affirmant believes it to be true; and the reason this verification is made by affirmant and not by the plaintiff is because the plaintiff is not within the county in which your affirmant maintains his principal office. The grounds of affirmant's belief as to all matters not stated upon affirmant's knowledge are communications with the plaintiff, review of records and documents within affirmant's possession.

Affirmed: March 13, 2020



Jason A. Steinberger

Index Number:
SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

LOUCCHIE BROWN,

Plaintiff,

-against-

CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, POLICE
OFFICER GEORGE HINES, SHIELD 5160 OF THE 48 PRECINCT, SERGEANT
FRANKLIN BONILLA, TAX REG # 943010 OF THE 48 PRECINCT AND NEW YORK
CITY POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOE,

Defendant.

SUMMONS AND COMPLAINT

LAW OFFICES OF JASON A. STEINBERGER, LLC
505 Eighth Avenue, Suite 701
New York, NY 10018

To:
Attorney (s) for Defendant(s)

Service of a copy of the within

is hereby admitted.

Dated:

Attorney(s) for

PLEASE TAKE NOTICE

☐ that the within is a (certified) true copy of
☐ entered in the office of the clerk of the within named Court on

**NOTICE
OF ENTRY**

☐ that an Order of which the within is a true copy will be presented for settlement to the Hon.
NOTICE OF once of the Judges of the within named Court,
SETTLEMENT at

on

200 , at m.

Dated:

JASON A. STEINBERGER, ESQ.
505 Eighth Avenue, Suite 701
New York, NY 10018

To:
Attorney(s) for